Singapore Banks - Maybank Research 2026-02-04: What To Expect From 4Q25 Earnings Announcements?

> ## Singapore Banks: What To Expect From 4Q25 Earnings Announcements?

- See Earnings Calendar (https://sginvestors.io/news/sgx-stocks-earnings-calendar) – DBS (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/d05-dbs/stock-info) to report 4Q25 earnings on 9 Feb, UOB (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/u11-uob/stock-info) on 24 Feb and OCBC (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/[illegible]9-ocbc-bank/stock-info) on 25 Feb. We expect mixed sequential earnings with UOB posting growth off a low base, while DBS and OCBC are likely to be flat to negative.
- NII is likely to hold steady q-o-q from higher loans momentum and liquidity inflows. NoII is likely to be slower q-o-q from seasonally weaker wealth management.

However, markets and loan related fees should give downside support.



- Costs and asset quality have low negative surprise risks. DBS and OCBC have higher upside risks for dividend surprises given strong capital buffers and write-backs.

NII Finding A Base With Better Loan Growth.

- SORA contraction is stabilizing. After falling -60vps q-o-q in 3Q, it fell - 27bps in 4Q. Concurrently, HIBOR is still +126bps higher than Aug 25. The sector has also been reducing deposit rates actively. These should slow NIM compression.
- System loan were +5% y-o-y in 2025, ahead of our expectation. This was driven by rising construction, mortgage, SME lending. This is further support to NIMs.
- OCBC likely benefitted the most from strong gearing to domestic SMEs, followed by DBS from mortgages and large-corps. With the sector parking excess liquidity in HQLA, NII is unlikely to see material y-o-y contraction.
- For FY26, we expect guidance to shift from NIMs to NII, with Management's expecting flat-to-positive NII growth.

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NoII Slower Seasonally. Credit Cards, Loan Fees Positive.

- 3Q25 fee momentum expanded +12.6% q-o-q, led by wealth management. Low interest rates and risk-on client sentiment supported rotation from low-yielding FDs to wealth products.
- Seasonally, 4Q is slower given the holiday season, so fee growth should decelerate. OCBC may see the least loss in momentum due to support from loan fees as well as brokerage. UOB could see improved credit card fees following a low base affected by high Thai rewards redemptions in 3Q.
- Overall trading income – especially client flows – are likely to remain supported given high levels of volatility.

NPL, CIR Benign. Higher Final Dividends Risks.

- 9M CIR was ~40%. We expect FY25 to close at a similar run rate. UOB likely exception with higher IT costs as the Group invests in upgrading its Retail platform. Credit costs surprised significantly for UOB in 3Q from pre-emptive provisions for CRE exposures.
- We expect q-o-q contraction of credit costs, but these may likely remain elevated. Contrastingly, given a slightly better macro outlook so far in FY26, there are upside risks of GP write-backs for DBS and OCBC, in our view.

Potential Dividend Surprises? Maintain POSITIVE.

- There could be potential ramp-ups in DBS's final dividends (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/d05-dbs/corporate-action) and OCBC's dividends (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/o39-ocbc-bank/corporate-action) given high capital, write-backs.

Above is an excerpt from a report by Maybank Research.
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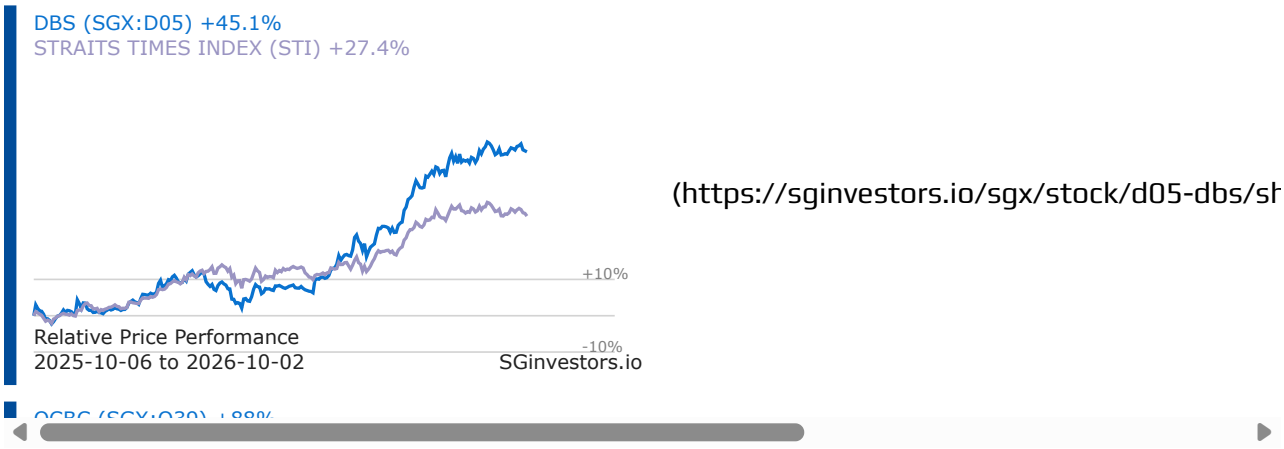
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